ANSWER KEY

QP CODE: 25900571

MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-UGP (HONOURS) Regular EXAMINATION October 2025

THIRD SEMESTER

Discipline Specific Core Course (DSC) - MG3DSCPOL203 - HUMAN RIGHTS IN INDIA

(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

PART A

1. Right to life and liberty; right to property.

2. Provides subsidized food grains to eligible households under National Food Security Act,2013.

3. Protection of Children from Sexual Offences Act, 2012.

4. Restricts freedom of expression and access to information.

5. Universal and inalienable.

6. First-generation rights.

7. Jammu & Kashmir and Northeastern states like Manipur and Assam.

8. Articles 29 and 30.

9. Protect the rights of people displaced within their own country due to conflict, human rights violations, or disasters.

10. Forced removal or extermination of an ethnic group.

PART B

11. Magna Carta limited absolute monarchy -established the principle that rulers are subject to law- inspiring modern democratic ideals such as due process, equality before law, and protection of individual rights.

12. NHRC promotes democracy by ensuring government accountability- investigating human rights violations, recommending reforms- spreading awareness on constitutional rights and justice for marginalized communities.

13. NCPCR consists of a chairperson and six members- examining policies affecting children-monitoring child rights violations- recommending reforms, and ensuring laws like POCSO and RTE are effectively implemented.

14. Ethical journalism protects human rights by promoting truth accountability, and transparency-exposes abuses, prevents misinformation, and ensures the media acts as a watchdog for democracy and justice.

15. Rehabilitation and vocational training reform prisoners- providing skills, education, and psychological support-reducing recidivism, and preparing them for reintegration as productive, law-abiding members of society.

16. Ram Mohan Roy pioneered human rights by challenging social evils like sati- promoting freedom of speech, women's rights, education, and rationalism- laying the foundation for modern reform movements in India.

17. Judicial review allows courts to examine the constitutionality of laws and executive actions, ensuring they align with the Constitution -protecting citizens' rights from arbitrary or unlawful government actions.

18. Persons with disabilities face barriers such as inaccessible infrastructure, social stigma-lack of inclusive education, and inadequate job opportunities- preventing their full participation in education and employment sectors.

19. Human Rights Law Network (HRLN) has been highly effective in influencing policy reforms on human rights issues in India through a combination of strategic public interest litigation (PIL), legal aid, and integrated advocacy-HRLN's strategic litigation and advocacy have influenced policy reforms by challenging human rights violations in courts, ensuring justice for vulnerable groups- pressing governments to implement rights-based policies.

20. Bulldozer justice violates the rule of law by bypassing legal procedures, denying fair hearings, and promoting arbitrary state action, undermining judicial authority, due process, and citizens' constitutional rights.

PART C

21. UDHR profoundly influenced international human rights movements by establishing a universal framework for dignity, equality, and freedom-inspired global treaties, national constitutions, and activism- leading to institutions and norms that protect individuals from state abuse and promote justice worldwide.

22. Right to Equality ensures equal treatment before law, while the Right to Freedom guarantees expression, movement, and association-together, they empower citizens, prevent discrimination, and enable participation in governance- forming the moral and legal foundation of India's democratic and inclusive political system.

23. Vishaka Guidelines (1997) and the POSH Act (2013) defined and criminalized workplace sexual harassment- making employers responsible for prevention and redressal-they institutionalized gender-sensitive mechanisms- empowering women to work safely and promoting equality, dignity, and justice within India's professional and social spaces.

24. Right to Privacy- upheld in the Puttaswamy judgment (2017)- vital to human dignity and autonomy-safeguards individuals from state surveillance, data misuse, and intrusion, ensuring personal liberty, freedom of choice, democratic accountability—core components of modern human rights protection.